Where we win, what it earns, and what to bid next

Bid intelligence for Weibee Steel. A working data-and-decisions loop, shown on synthetic data.

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Every bid teaches us something. Today the lesson stays in people's heads

We know we 'do well on schools', but not the hit rate with a denominator, by type, size, distance and customer.

The estimate and the job's final cost never meet. We do not know which kinds of work keep their margin and which give it back.

Estimating hours go wherever the invitations come from. Nobody ranks the invitations before a week of takeoff starts.

The posting asks for someone to build exactly this loop: the GC database, bid results, pricing feedback, why we win or lose, and a bid/no-bid process.

What the pipeline does, in four steps

1. Collect

Every invitation, bid, result, low-bid number and job close-out in one place.

2. Measure

Hit rates with denominators. Estimated versus realised margin. Dollars won per estimating hour.

3. Rank

Every upcoming project scored: win odds, margin we really keep, estimating cost, shop load.

4. Decide

A Pursue / Review / Pass list for the Monday bid meeting. The room overrides; the override is logged.

The business at a glance, trailing twelve months

25%

Hit rate

20 of 80 decided bids; prior year 33%

$19.4M

Value won

5,088 tons

16 weeks

Won work waiting for the shop

2,286 tons at 140 tons a week

50%

How full the shop looks next year

won work plus upcoming work at its odds

4.5 pts

Margin estimated but not kept

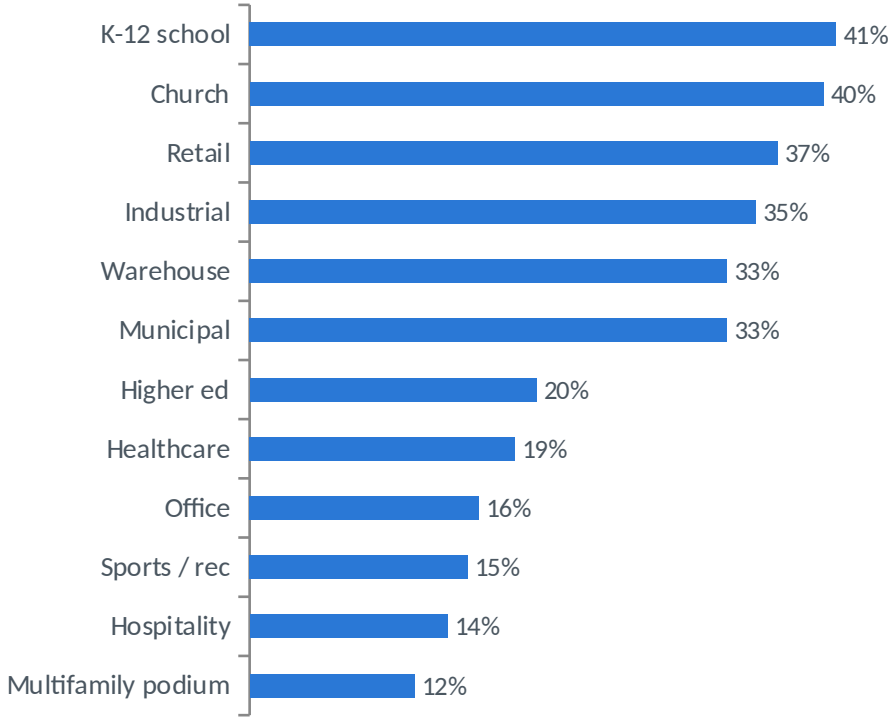
estimated 22.9%, actually earned 18.3%

29 of 90

Upcoming projects worth chasing

about 700 estimating hours to bid them

Where the shop fits: hit rate by kind of project



Three kinds of work win 37 to 41% and keep their margin.

Three others win 12 to 15% and give back 7 to 10 points of margin once built.

The bottom three took 29% of estimating hours for 18% of the dollars won.

Action: default them to Review. Bid them when a relationship GC asks, not on a hard bid.

Who awards us work, and who only checks their numbers against us

Seven price shoppers

- Award us 18% of what we price for them
- We are 11% high when we lose
- 2,650 estimating hours for $19.1M won

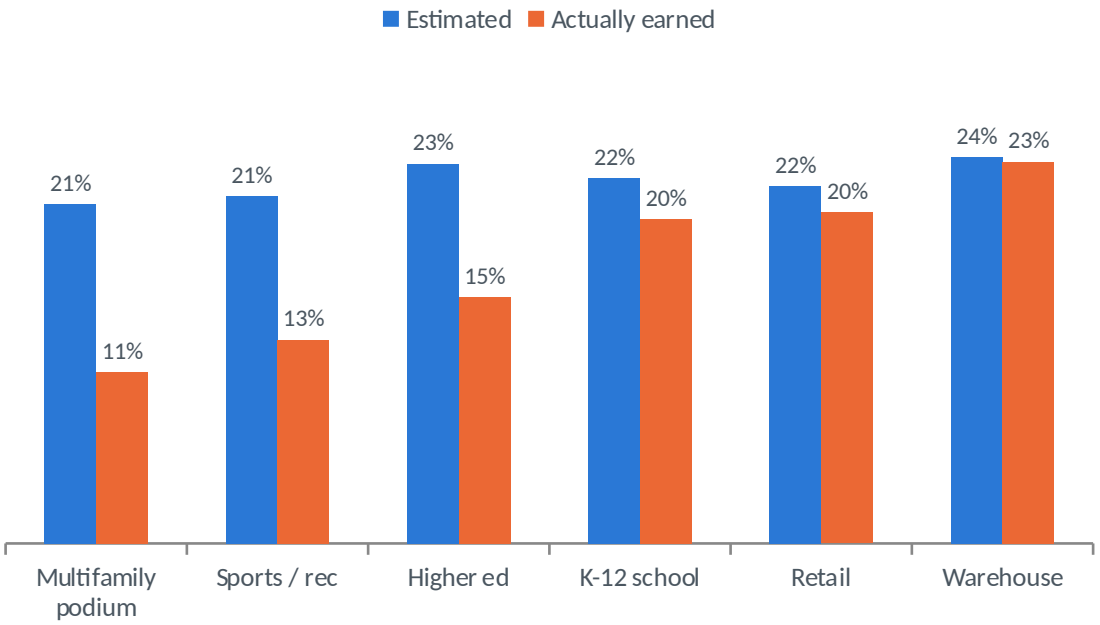
Bid them only when the shop needs fill-in work.

Four A-class accounts

- Award us 40% or more
- Jobs earn at or above shop margin
- 1,920 estimating hours for $29.4M won

Spend the hours here, and on new GCs that look like them.

The margin we estimated but did not keep



4.5 pts

Gross margin not kept

estimated 22.9%, earned 18.3%, 95 jobs

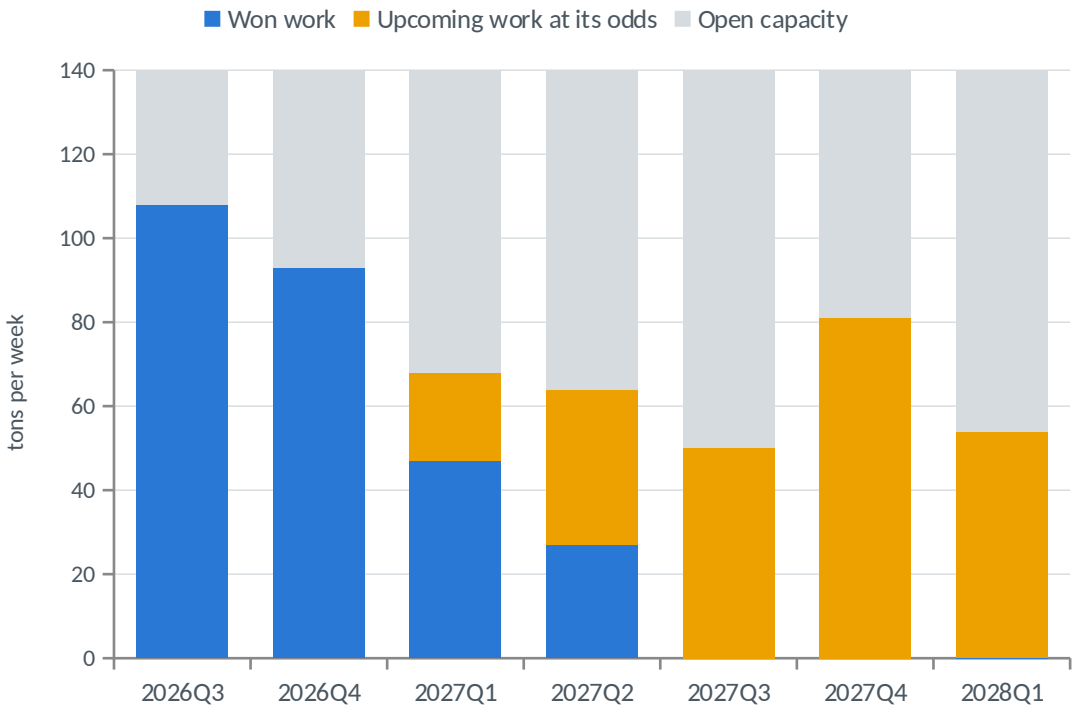
$4.3M

In the bid, not in the bank

complex, far-away and change-order-heavy work slips most

Action: put realised margin by project type back into the estimate as a line item, not a flat markup.

Can the shop take what we are chasing?



The shop does 140 tons a week.

Won work covers 16 weeks.

From the first quarter of next year the shop is less than half full unless the pipeline converts.

Target: roughly 9,000 more tons of identified opportunities at today's hit rate.

The Monday tool: every upcoming project, ranked, with a call and the reasons

Ranked opportunities (next 6-24 months, top 20 of 90)

#	Call	Project	GC	Type	Tons	Miles	Delivery	Win odds	EV / est. hr	Shop load if won	Why
1	Pursue	Industrial - Stillwater #24	Caddo Construction	Industrial / manufacturing	398	83	Design-build	52%	$6k	82%	design-build delive
2	Pursue	Municipal - Norman #23	Flint Hills Construction	Municipal / civic	134	13	Negotiated	83%	$6k	74%	negotiated delivery
3	Pursue	Industrial - Muskogee #3	Meridian Build Partners	Industrial / manufacturing	494	133	Design-build	43%	$5k	72%	design-build delive
4	Pursue	Industrial - Oklahoma City #11	Boomer Construction Group	Industrial / manufacturing	923	32	CM at risk	36%	$5k	69%	no flags
5	Pursue	K-12 school - Tulsa #26	Sooner State Contractors	K-12 school	175	120	Negotiated	65%	$5k	63%	relationship GC (43 bids); project type well; negotiated de
6	Pursue	Industrial - Oklahoma City #45	Summit Ridge Construction	Industrial / manufacturing	1,330	30	Hard bid	24%	$4k	69%	no flags
7	Pursue	Municipal - Tulsa #61	Meridian Build Partners	Municipal / civic	196	126	Design-build	53%	$4k	62%	design-build delive
8	Review	Municipal - Muskogee #32	Cimarron Commercial	Municipal / civic	145	136	Negotiated	62%	$4k	98%	shop tight (98%) d window; negotiatec
9	Pursue	Industrial - Stillwater #49	Flint Hills Construction	Industrial / manufacturing	338	83	CM at risk	37%	$4k	55%	no flags
10	Pursue	Industrial - Moore #30	Washita Valley Builders	Industrial / manufacturing	414	21	CM at risk	36%	$4k	75%	no flags
11	Pursue	Warehouse - Broken Arrow #48	Heartland Build Co	Warehouse / distribution	336	126	CM at risk	37%	$4k	52%	no flags
12	Pursue	Industrial - Edmond #87	Meridian Build Partners	Industrial / manufacturing	276	43	CM at risk	39%	$3k	76%	no flags
13	Pursue	Healthcare - Norman #51	Cross Timbers Contracting	Healthcare	323	13	Negotiated	41%	$3k	59%	negotiated delivery

Pursue — **29 projects**

698 estimating hours, 9,872 tons, $2.5M expected margin

Review — **26 projects**

451 estimating hours, 4,608 tons, $0.72M expected margin

Pass — **35 projects**

858 estimating hours, 9,961 tons, $0.53M expected margin

- Win odds from our own history with that kind of job and that customer.
- Expected value: odds x revenue x the margin we really keep, minus the cost of estimating it. Ranked per estimating hour.
- Shop load if we win it, over the weeks it would be in the shop.

A starting point for the bid meeting, not a verdict. The room overrides it and the override is logged.

How much to trust the win odds

0.75

Accuracy score (AUC)

0.5 is a coin flip, 1.0 is perfect

100 bids

Tested on bids it had never seen

fitted on bids before July 2025, checked on the ones after

Quarterly

Re-fit as results come in

every decided bid and low-bid number makes it better

The rule we would run it under

Good enough to rank projects and budget estimating hours. Not good enough to overrule the room on one job. The report says this in its own words, and the scorecard shows every input next to the call so the room can argue with the number.

What it takes to run this on Weibee Steel's own numbers

Weeks 1 to 4

Learn the shop, build the intake

Shadow estimating, PM, QC, shop and field. Load three years of bid logs and job closes. Phone the GCs we lost to for the low number.

Weeks 5 to 8

Get the numbers live

Hit rate, customer and estimate-versus-actual pages on real history. Sit with estimators and PMs until the definitions are right.

Weeks 9 to 13

Turn on the Monday scorecard

Rank the pipeline, set the estimating-hour budget, log overrides. Review the capacity chart with shop leadership monthly.

What we would need: the bid log, job-cost close-outs and a list of general contractors. Most shops already have all three, in three different places. No licences: Python and a free database, one afternoon a quarter to re-fit.

Every bid teaches us something. This puts the lesson in a table and on the Monday agenda.

Report, PDF, data and code are in the repository. All data is synthetic; the method runs unchanged on real history.

Thank you